



A CALL TO PREPARE

To Pastors, Ministry Leaders, and Community Leaders

"Preparation is wisdom in advance."

Proverbs 6:6–8 tells us to consider the ant. The ant does not wait for winter to arrive before gathering its food. It prepares in advance. We have received many warnings, and we have witnessed events that remind us how quickly circumstances can change:

- Food recalls continue across our nation.
- Communities like Gary, Indiana, and Memphis, Tennessee have recently experienced severe events that left people in need of food, water, power, shelter, and basic resources.

We cannot sit back and wait until a crisis hits to begin preparing.

Build Your Ark began after D'Andrea Bolden received two powerful dreams instructing her to create a survival and preparedness manual. What began as *It's Time to Build Your Ark* has grown into an online hub designed to help individuals, families, pastors, leaders, churches, and communities prepare:

- Physically
- Mentally
- Spiritually
- Financially
- Practically
- Collectively

I believe prophetic warnings are not given only for us to pray. Sometimes God gives us warning so that we can pray, seek His direction, and prepare.

- *"Sometimes the warning is for the preparation. Sometimes it is for the instruction. Sometimes it is so we are not blindsided."*

Joseph was given seven years of warning before the famine. He did not wait until the famine arrived to begin storing grain. He used the time he had been given to use the word of wisdom and prepare.

Note: We are almost seven years removed from COVID-19. We have had time to learn, observe, rebuild, and prepare. Let us take this time seriously.

AS LEADERS, WE MUST REMEMBER

The people who will need help when crisis comes are already among us:

- Widows and fatherless children
- Single mothers

- The elderly and people with disabilities
- Families already struggling
- Those experiencing homelessness
- Others who may not have the resources to prepare for themselves

The vulnerable will not suddenly become vulnerable when crisis arrives. They are already among us. Preparing is therefore not simply about protecting ourselves it is about positioning ourselves to help others.

WHAT WE NEED

- Churches and communities that have plans
- People who know how to respond
- Supplies that have already been gathered
- Relationships that have already been established
- Trusted people who can work together
- Leaders who are willing to see beyond today

The ant prepares before winter. Joseph prepared before famine. Noah built before the rain.

The lesson is simple: Do not wait for the crisis to convince you that preparation was necessary.

- We have been given warnings.
- We have been given time.
- We have been given an opportunity.

Let us use it wisely.

THE TIME IS NOW

- The time to build is before the storm.
- The time to gather is before the shortage.
- The time to strengthen our communities is before the crisis.
- The time to prepare is now.

It is time to build our ark.

D'Andrea Bolden

Visionary, Build Your Ark

buildyourark.substack.com